

# Bentresh Stela (Louvre C 284)

Notes by Minh-Tâm Trinh

I warmly thank Mary Becker, Galen Goldsmith, Dieter Hoffmann, Rachel McEnroe, Foy Scalf, Dawn Schreiner, and Eric Whitacre for their input.

## *Glossing Conventions*

(May not match the conventions in my older notes)

|         |                                                       |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| (     ) | text omitted by the scribe, but implicitly understood |
| <     > | addition to fix a scribal error                       |
| {     } | deletion to fix a scribal error                       |
| [     ] | addition to fix lacuna, or addition uncertain         |

## *References*

[C 284]            Stèle de Bakhtan [CM 463 ; BN 50 ; E 13481 ; C 284]. Département des Antiquités égyptiennes. Louvre site des collections.  
<https://collections.louvre.fr/en/ark:/53355/cl010029573>

[B]                M. Broze. *La princesse de Bakhtan : Essai d'analyse stylistique*. Monographies Reine Élisabeth. Fondation gÉgyptologique Reine Élisabeth. Bruxelles (1989).

[D]                A. Dollinger. "The Bentresh Stela." Egyptian Texts of the Late and Ptolemaic Periods, §3.1. *Attalus*. Last updated August 1, 2020. Accessed October 18, 2025. [https://www.attalus.org/egypt/bentresh\\_stela.html](https://www.attalus.org/egypt/bentresh_stela.html)

[DB]              A story designed to make propaganda for the cult of Khonsu (The Bentresh-Stela...). In *Egyptian Reading Book, Vol. I: Exercises and Middle Egyptian Texts*. Ed. A. De Buck. Nederlandsch Archaeologisch-Philologisch Instituut. Leyden (1948). 106–109.

[F]                R. O. Faulkner. *A Concise Dictionary of Middle Egyptian*. Griffith Institute, Ashmolean Museum, Oxford. Reprinted at the University Press, Oxford (1981).

[G]                A. Gardiner. *Egyptian Grammar: Being an Introduction to the Study of Hieroglyphs*. 3rd Edition, Revised. Griffith Institute, Ashmolean Museum, Oxford. Printed at the University Press, Cambridge (2007).

[H]                J. E. Hoch. *Middle Egyptian Grammar*. Benben Publications. Mississauga (1997).

[L] III. Two Pseudepigrapha: The Bentresh Stela. In *Ancient Egyptian Literature, Vol. III: The Late Period*. Trans. M. Lichtheim. University of California Press. Berkeley (1980). 90–93.

[N] M.-J. Nederhof. “Bentresh Stela.” Last updated November 4, 2006. [https://mqtrinh.github.io/other/egyptian/middle-egyptian/bentresh-stela\\_trans-nederhof.pdf](https://mqtrinh.github.io/other/egyptian/middle-egyptian/bentresh-stela_trans-nederhof.pdf)

[TLA] Thesaurus Linguae Aegyptiae. Version 2.2.0. Union of the German Academies of Sciences and Humanities. <https://tla.digital/home>

11/17/25

(1) *Hr K3 Nht*  
*tw t h<sup>c</sup>.w*  
*dd ns.y(t) mi (I)tm*

*Hr Nb w*  
*ws(r) hpšw dr Pdt 9*

*Nsw Bity Nb T3.wy*  
*Wsr-M<sup>c</sup>3.t-R<sup>c</sup> Stp-(n)-R<sup>c</sup>*

*S3 R<sup>c</sup>*  
*ht=f Mri-Imn R<sup>c</sup>-ms-s(w)*

*Imn-R<sup>c</sup> (2) Nb Nsw.t Psd.t Nb.wt W3s.t*  
*mri ntr nfr Imn*  
*ms.[tī]w R<sup>c</sup>-Hr-3h.ty*  
*pr.w h n Nb Dr.(t)*  
*wtt n K3-Mwt=f*  
*nsw.t n Km.t hk3 Dšr.wt*  
*ity (3) it Pdt 9*  
*pri m ht*  
*sr(w) n=f nh.tw*  
*wd n=f pri<sup>c</sup> m swh.t*

(1) Horus, Mighty Bull,  
 perfect [F 295] of appearance [F 185] [*nfr hr*],  
 enduring of kingship [*nfr hr*], like Atum,

Golden Horus,  
 strong [F 68] of arm [*nfr hr*] [who] drives away the Nine Bows [*pd.t psd.t*],

Dual King, Lord of the Two Lands,  
 Usermaatre Setepenre,

Son of Re,  
 his presence [F 200], Meriamun Rameses,

Amun-Re, (2) Lord of the Thrones [*cf.* G 627 and TLA 26200] [of] the Ennead, of the  
 Ladies of Thebes<sup>1</sup>,  
 beloved of the good god, Amun,  
 bo[r]n of Re-Horakhty,  
 seed [F 91] of the *akh* of the Lord of Ancestors[? F 324],  
 begotten of Kamutef,  
 king of the Black Land<sup>2</sup>, ruler of the Red Land<sup>3</sup>,

1 *W3s.t* = Waset = “The Scepter”.

2 *Km.t* = Kemet.

3 *Dšr.wt* = Deshrut.

sovereign **(3)** [who] seized the Nine Bows,  
that when he came forth from the womb [second tense?],  
victories [F 139] were foretold [passive] [F 235] of him,  
command [F 73–74] [given] to him [while] active [F 91] in the egg,

12/7/25

*k3 mn ib hb=f mtwn*  
*nsw.t n ntr pri nh.t mi Mnt(w)*  
*wr ph.ty (4) mi s3 Nw.t*

*is hm=f m Nhrn mi n(y)t-<sup>c</sup>=f tnw rnp.t*  
*wr.w n h3s.t nb iw<=sn> m ks.w m htp.w n b3.w n hm=f š3<sup>c</sup> <r> phw.w*

Bull firm [F 106] of heart [*nfr hr*], when he trots [circumstantial?] [F 158] [into] the arena [variant spelling, F 121],  
divine king [indirect genitive] [who] came [no gemination, so perfect participle] [in] might like Montu,  
Great of strength [playful spelling of dual -ty] [leopard heads?] [*nfr hr*] **(4)** like the son of Nut:

So, his majesty [was] in Naharina like [that] of his custom [*cf.* H 248] each [F 305] year.  
[As for] the princes of every foreign land [F 185], they came in prostrations [F 287], in peace [“peaces”], to the might [*b3.w* = mass noun?] of his majesty, as far as the far north [F 92, last variant spelling].

12/21/25

*inw=sn nbw hsb(5) mfk3.t h3.w nb t3-ntr hr psd=sn*  
*w<sup>c</sup> nb hr hrp snw=f*  
*h<sup>c</sup> rdi{.t} p3 wr n Bhtn in.tw in.w=f*  
*di.n=f s3.t=f wr.t h3t ir.w[?]*  
*hr sw3š{y} hm=f*  
*hr dbh [nh] hr=f*  
*wn (6) st nfr(.ti?) r 3 wr hr ib hm=f r ht nb*

[As for] their tribute [F 22]: gold, lapis lazuli, **(5)** turquoise [F 106], every herb [F 183] from the gods’ land [were] upon their back[s].  
Each one was outdoing [F 196, “getting ahead of”] his companion.  
Then the chief of Bakhtan caused that his tribute be brought.  
[and] put his eldest daughter in front of [?],  
[and] was praising [F 216] his majesty,  
[and] was pleading [F 311] [for] [life] from [“upon”] him.

[*wn* as imperfect converter? TLA 550129] The **(6)** woman had been pleasing [stative?] to the utmost greatness upon his majesty's heart, than any thing [else].

1/4/26

ḥ<sup>c</sup>.n wdn(.w) nhb(.t)=s Nsw.t Wr.t Nfr.w-R<sup>c</sup>  
 spr ḥm=f r Km.t  
 ir.n=s irty nb ḥm.t-nsw

hpr ḥsb.t 15 šmw (2) sw 22  
 isk ḥm=f m W3s.t Nh.t Hm.t Niw.wt  
 hr ir{y}<.t> **(7)** ḥs(ty) n (i)t=f Imn-R<sup>c</sup> Nb Nsw.t T3.wy  
 m hb=f nfr n Ip(.t) s.t ib=f nt sp tp  
 ii.tw r dd n ḥm=f  
 wn wp.(wt) ii.n p3 wr n Bhtn iw hr in.w ṣš(3){t} n nsw.t

Then her titulary [F 138] was recorded [F 73] [past passive]: Great Queen Neferure.  
 As the king returned [second tense?] to the Black Land,  
 so she did every doing [which noun form?] of a king's wife [direct genitive].

It happened in regnal year 15, month 2 [playful spelling], day 22,  
 lo ["non-enclitic" particle, TLA 31760; see also F 30], his majesty [was] in Mighty  
 Thebes, Wife of the Cities,  
 [and] was doing **(7)** the rites [F 177] for his father [*f* for both *it* and =*f*?], Amun-Re,  
 Lord of Thrones of the Two Lands [TLA 26200],  
 in his fine feast of Luxor<sup>4</sup> [F 16], his heart's place [direct genitive] since ["from"] the  
 beginning of time ["foremost time"],  
 [when] one came to say to his majesty:  
 There was [imperfect converter] a messenger [F 17, 60] of the chief of Bakhtan that  
 came, with[?] numerous [F 49] presents have come for the queen.

1/18/26

ḥ<sup>c</sup>.n ms(.w)[?]=f **(8)** m-b3ḥ ḥm=f ḥn<sup>c</sup> in.w=f  
 dd=f m sw3š ḥm=f  
 iw n=k R<sup>c</sup> n Pdt 9 imi nn ḥnh hr=k  
 ḥ<sup>c</sup>.n dd=f sn-t3 m-b3ḥ ḥm=f whm=f dd hr ḥm=f  
 ii=i n=k it- **(9)** -y nb hr Bntrš snw.t kt n ḥm.t-nsw Nfr.w-R<sup>c</sup>  
 mn 3bḥ(.w) m ḥ<sup>c</sup>w=s

Then he was brought [F 116] **(8)** before ["into the potency of"] [F 77–78] his majesty,  
 with his gifts,  
 [and] he said, in praising [F 216] his majesty,

4 *Ip(.t)* = Ipet = "The Adyton".

Hail to you, Re of the Nine Bows! Give us life from you!  
 Then he spoke [tribute], kissing the earth [TLA 888530] [typo for *t3* in De Buck?]  
 before his majesty, [and] he continued, saying to his majesty:  
 I have come to you, sovereign, lord, on [account of] Bentresh, the younger [“other”]  
 daughter of the king’s wife Neferure.  
 Illness has seized [F 2] her body.

**2/1/26**

*im{t}{[?]} wd hm=k rh-(i)h.t r m3=s*  
*h<sup>c</sup> dd.n hm=f*  
*in n=i tt(iw) nt pr-<sup>c</sup>nh knb.(w)t (10) nt tnw*  
*st3.n=f hr-<sup>c</sup>(wy)*  
*dd hm=f*  
*mt(n) rti (tw) <sup>c</sup>s{t}.tw n {t}<t>n r sdm=tn mdw tn*  
*isk in n=i hmw.t m ib=f sš m db<sup>c</sup>w=f m k(3)b=tn*  
*ii pw <ir> n sš (11) nsw tn Dhwti-m-Hb m-b3h hm=f*  
*wd.n hm=f šmy=f r Bhtn hn<sup>c</sup> wp.(wt) pn*  
*spr pw ir n rh-(i)h.t r Bhtn*  
*gm.n=f Bntrš m šhr hr <sup>c</sup>h.yw*

O [that] your majesty [would] command a wise man [missing determinative? F 151]  
 to inspect [F 100] her.

Then his majesty spoke:

Bring to me the staff [TLA 177470] of the temple [“house of life”], the councils [F 280] (10) of the residence.

They were ushered in [F 255] immediately [F 175].

Spoke his majesty:

Look, it was caused that you were summoned [F 48] to this, in order that you hear  
 [prospective] these words.

Now, bring to me a craftsman [F 170] in his heart, a scribe in his fingers, [from]  
 within your midst [F 275].

There was a coming by a royal (11) scribe, this Thothemheb [*hb* on F 167], before his  
 majesty.

His majesty commanded that he go forth to Bakhtan with this messenger.

There was an arrival by this wise man to Bakhtan,

[where] he found Bentresh in the state [F 242–243] of [being] upon spirits [F 4],

**4/19/26**

*gm.n=f (12) sw hry n h3 hn<sup>c</sup>=f*  
*wn wr n Bhtn wh[m=f h(3)b m-b3h] hm=f m dd*  
*ity nb=i im wd. {tw} hm=f rdi in.tw ntr[...]*

(13) *r hm=f n rnp.t sp 26 3bd (1) šmw sw ifd hb Imn*  
*iw hm=f m W3s.t*

[where] he found **(12)** him[self] an enemy [F 195] [L 370, 372] for fight[ing] with him.

There was [imperfect converter] a chief of Bakhtan that [“he”] relayed the message in the presence of his majesty, saying:

Sovereign, my lord, may your majesty command to cause to be brought a god[...]

**(13)** [to] his majesty in year 26, the first month of summer,<sup>5</sup> day four [of] the festival of Amun,  
while his majesty was in Thebes:

**4/19/26**

*ḥḥ.n whm.n hm=f*

Then his majesty relayed

---

<sup>5</sup> *šmw* = Shemu = “Harvest”.